ELENA ROTZOKOU

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Research Profile: PhD candidate in English and Comparative Literature at Columbia University, specializing in British poetry of the long eighteenth century and the Romantic period. My research examines lyric form, temporality, and how poems take in ecological, medical, and colonial knowledge, from the poetics of repetition, reticence, and retrospection in Clare and Keats to the biocolonial ecosystem of James Grainger's *The Sugar-Cane* (1764). My articles have appeared in *European Romantic Review*, *Early American Studies*, and *ARIEL*. Beyond academic publishing, I write criticism for general readers, with essays in *Public Seminar* and forthcoming in *Public Books*.

EDUCATION

Columbia University | New York, NY | Aug 2023–present
PhD, English and Comparative Literature (in progress)
MA, English and Comparative Literature
- MA Essay: "I cannot recollect it': Eco-social Detritus and Forms of Reticence in Keats's Poems and Letters from Scotland"

(MA Essay Supervisor: Dr. Joseph Albernaz; runner-up, Miron Cristo-Loveanu Prize)

University of Oxford, Blackfriars Hall | Oxford, UK | Aug 2021–May 2022
MSt, English (1700–1830)
- Dissertation: "Repetition and Clare's Lyric of Withdrawn Revelation" (Supervisor: Dr. Erica McAlpine)

University College Dublin | Dublin, Ireland | Jan–May 2020
API Study Abroad (semester abroad)

Wagner College | Staten Island, NY | Aug 2017–May 2021
BA, English Literature (Major) & Philosophy (Minor) (GPA: 3.99, summa cum laude)
- Honors Thesis: "'Centre and Circumference': The Status of the Object and the Formation of Aesthetic Experience in Shelley's 'Alastor' and 'Mont Blanc'" (Supervisor: Dr. Susan Bernardo)

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

- Rotzokou, Elena. "Alien Mixtures: Health and Disease in *The Sugar-Cane*'s Biocolonial Ecosystem." *Early American Studies* 24, no. 3 (2026): 286–311.
- Rotzokou, Elena. "Repetition and Clare's Lyric of Withdrawn Revelation." *European Romantic Review* 36, no. 1 (2025): 119–141.
- Rotzokou, Elena. "Misreading the Air: Narrative Ambivalence and the Burden of Representation in Dinaw Mengestu's *How to Read the Air*." *ARIEL: A Review of International English Literature* 55, nos. 3-4 (July–October 2024): 49–75.

SELECTED PUBLIC-FACING WRITING

- "Tennyson in Deep Time" — *Public Books* (forthcoming, January 2027)
- "An Embarrassment of Exactness in Ben Lerner's *Transcription*" — *Public Seminar* (20 July 2026)
- "Embracing change" — *FMCG CEO Magazine*, 30 March 2023
- "Europe takes the lead in sustainable growth: Digital Product Passports" — *Sustainable Plastics*, 24 March 2023
- "2023 and Packaging: What have we seen so far" — *Manufacturing & Engineering Magazine*, 31 January 2023
- "What's in a name? Buildings and the politics of nomenclature" — *Cherwell* (University of Oxford), 17 February 2022
- "Collective security and individual freedom in the Covid era: how clear-cut of a conflict is there?" — *Cherwell* (University of Oxford), 8 February 2022
- "The life-sucking vampire: exams and the logic of capitalism" — *Cherwell* (University of Oxford), 10 June 2022

TEACHING & TUTORING

Teaching Assistant, Columbia University | New York, NY | Fall 2026
- Course: "*Frankenstein* and Its Vicissitudes" (ENGL GU4132), lecture taught by Dr. Eleanor Johnson.
- Lead weekly discussion sections.
- Hold office hours; grade papers and exams.

Teaching Assistant, Columbia University | New York, NY | Spring 2025
- Course: "Children's Literature" (ENGL UN1075), undergraduate lecture taught by Dr. James Adams.

- Held office hours; graded papers and exams.

Teaching Assistant, Columbia University | New York, NY | Fall 2024
- Course: "Romantic Poetry" (ENGL UN2402), undergraduate lecture taught by Dr. Erik Gray.
- Led weekly discussion sections.
- Held office hours; graded papers and exams.

Tutor of English, Students4Students | Oxford, UK | Mar 2022–Jun 2022
- Volunteered once a week at St Barnabas Church of England Primary School.
- Provided support for Year 5 students in one-on-one and small-group settings.

English Language Tutor & Conversation Partner, El Centro del Inmigrante | Staten Island, NY | Feb 2021–May 2021
- Organized weekly topic-based conversation sessions with emphasis on speaking and listening skills.

Writing Intensive Tutor, Wagner College | Staten Island, NY | Jan 2018–May 2021
- Met one-on-one with students multiple times per week to strengthen argumentation, structure, grammar, and citation practice.
- Supported brainstorming/outlining and provided targeted feedback on revision.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- "The Poem Before the Poem: Keats's Inductions and the Time of Retrospection" — British Association for Romantic Studies (BARS) International Conference, University of Birmingham, UK (virtual), 6 Aug 2026
- "'I cannot recollect it': Eco-social Detritus and Forms of Reticence in Keats's Poems and Letters from Scotland" — Keats Conference 2025, Hampstead, London, UK, 16 May 2025
- "Aching Time, Slow Time: Temporality, Poetry, and Revolution in Keats" — North American Society for the Study of Romanticism (NASSR), Georgetown University, Washington, D.C., 17 Aug 2024
- "Repetition and Clare's Lyric of Withdrawn Revelation: A Twist on Allegorical Doublespeak" — MLA Convention (virtual), 5 Jan 2023
- "'Man, inwardly contemplated': The Legacy of Enlightenment Universalism in Book VIII of Wordsworth's 1805 Prelude" — Wordsworth Summer Conference, Cumbria, UK, 17 Aug 2022

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, & AWARDS

- Columbia University GSAS Matching Conference Travel Grant — Aug 2024
- Marjorie Hope Nicolson Fellowship — Aug 2023–May 2029
- Ena Wordsworth Bursary — Aug 2022
- English Literature Prize (Wagner College) — May 2021
- Sigma Tau Delta International English Honor Society — Feb 2019–present
- Wagner College Honors Program — Jan 2018–May 2021
- Wagner College Dean's List — Fall 2017–May 2021
- Wagner Plan Award (academic merit) — Fall 2017–May 2021
- Wagner International Award (academic merit) — Fall 2017–May 2021

EMPLOYMENT

Editorial Assistant, Department of English and Comparative Literature Newsletter, Columbia University | New York, NY | Sep 2026–present
- In charge of the newsletter's September feature: conducted interviews and wrote the feature article.

Help Desk Assistant Librarian, Butler Library, Columbia University | New York, NY | Sep 2026–present
- Assist students with inquiries about how to use the library's resources.

Global EPR Researcher, Ecoveritas Ltd. | Oxford, UK | Jun 2022–Jul 2023
- Researched Extended Producer Responsibility laws worldwide and produced clear written reports and informational articles.
- Built and maintained structured Excel spreadsheets; delivered PowerPoint presentations and led training sessions.
- Authored and published industry analysis pieces on EPR policy and sustainable packaging across outlets including *FMCG CEO Magazine*, *Manufacturing & Engineering Magazine*, and *Sustainable Plastics*.
- Liaised internally and externally.

Examination Support Assistant, Greene's College Oxford | Oxford, UK | Apr 2022–May 2022
- Supported administration of A-Level examinations by following strict procedures and maintaining confidentiality.
- Prepared examination rooms and materials; welcomed and escorted students; distributed and collected exam papers accurately.

FURTHER EXPERIENCE & TRAINING

Participant, Camp eLabs, Center for Digital Editing, University of Virginia | Charlottesville, VA | Aug 2026

- Selected by application to attend a fully funded (NEH-supported) four-day workshop on digital scholarly editing.
- Trained in project conceptualization, data modeling, TEI/XML markup, and building digital editions for the web.
- Developed a proposed digital edition of James Grainger's *The Sugar-Cane* (1764), representing the poem's interplay of verse, annotation, natural history, and medical knowledge.

Communications Officer | Students4Students | Oxford, UK | Feb 2022–Jun 2022

- Promoted the charity's Oxford branch on Facebook to help attract English and Math tutors.
- Liaised externally with Oxford University's Department of Education to co-organize a panel discussion on educational inequality, led by Dr. Steve Strand and held on 13 June 2022 at Balliol College.

Peer Reviewer, *Oxford Research in English*, University of Oxford | Oxford, UK | Oct 2021–Jun 2022

- Reviewed submissions and produced written reports on content, style, and tone within tight timelines.
- Communicated feedback and individual verdicts in board meetings.

Communications Officer | English Graduates at Oxford | Oxford, UK | Oct 2021–Jun 2022

- Managed the English graduate community's Facebook page by advertising events, talks, and conferences.
- Generated ideas about and took a leading role in organizing community events and social gatherings.

Editorial Assistant, The Quill Project, Pembroke College, University of Oxford | Oxford, UK | Mar 2022 (1 week)

- Proofread and digitally edited transcription work for the 1857 Oregon Constitution project.

Publishing Trainee, Insight into Publishing (Oxford University Careers Service) | Feb 2022

- Participated in sessions on publishing career pathways and a group strategy activity led by an executive publisher (Elsevier).

Communication & Promotion Intern, *Journal of Southeast European and Black Sea Studies* | Apr 2021–Oct 2021

- Created weekly social media posts to promote newly published articles; coordinated with authors on outreach.
- Created and updated Excel tracking sheets for content and publication workflow.

CREATIVE WORK (POETRY & FICTION)

- "Red Shift," *Rust & Moth* (Summer 2026)
- "Sleep Study," *Neologism* (June 2026)
- "Ration," *Josephine Quarterly* (Spring 2026)
- "Property Line," *Flash Frog* (18 May 2026)
- "ICU Waiting Room," "Late Summer, Smoke," *Still Point Journal* (7 April 2026)
- "rituals for unimportant mornings," "small cosmology of errands," "early days (field notes)," *Eunoia Review* (7 March 2026)
- "The Replacement," *Gooseberry Pie Lit Magazine* (March 2026)
- "After the Radiators Turn On," *ONE ART* (23 February 2026)

SKILLS

Digital scholarly editing (project conceptualization, data modeling, TEI/XML markup, editions for the web); **Textual and editorial work** (transcription review, proofreading, peer review, style consistency); **Research and writing** (library and bibliographic research, scholarly and public-facing prose, interviewing); **Tools** (Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint).